

Jiahao Chen

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Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor	expected May 2027
B.A. with Honors in Economics and Mathematics, University of Wisconsin–Madison	2019

Research Fields

Primary: Industrial Organization **Secondary:** Digital Economy, Economics of Innovation

Job Market Paper

Innovation Policy in Product-Line Markets: Evidence from GPUs [\[paper\]](#)

Summary. I develop a dynamic oligopoly model to quantify the returns to R&D and the effects of innovation policies in product-line markets. In such markets, firms invest in R&D to advance the technological frontier and adjust their product menus to serve heterogeneous consumers and to compete with rivals. I apply the model to the desktop graphics processing unit (GPU) market, a duopoly between Nvidia and AMD. I find that, over 2011–2020, the average dollar of private R&D generates about \$9 of within-market surplus net of that dollar, with the firms capturing \$3 and consumers the remainder. I then compare the two levers of innovation policy: an R&D credit that lowers the cost of research, and product rebates intended to raise its reward. Counterfactual simulations reveal that public support generates far less surplus per dollar than the average social return to private R&D. A subsidy on frontier products can even discourage innovation: it may lower prices for consumers and raise the firms' profit, but reduce the incentive to advance the cutting edge.

Work in Progress

Foundational Technology and Downstream Innovation: The Case of LLMs and Mobile Applications
Rhetoric, News, and Demand: How Information Style Shapes Consumer Behavior

Research Experience

Research Assistant, University of Chicago Booth School of Business	2019–2021
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Teaching Experience

<i>University of Michigan, undergraduate courses</i>	
Graduate Student Instructor, Matching and Market Design	2023, 2024, 2025
Graduate Student Instructor, Principles of Economics	Fall 2022

Fellowships and Awards

Rackham One-Term Fellowship	2026
Gerald C. and Theresa F. Timmis III Fellowship	2025
Graduate Research Award	2023, 2025
Rackham Graduate Student Research Grant	2024, 2025

Technical Skills

Programming: Python, R, MATLAB

References

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